

August

27

1883

Violent volcano

One of the most destructive volcanic eruptions reached its peak on the small Indonesian island of Krakatoa. More than 36,000 people died from the eruption and the tsunamis that followed.



Also on this day

1689 The **Treaty of Nerchinsk** was signed by Russia and China. It opened trade links to exchange goods between the two nations.

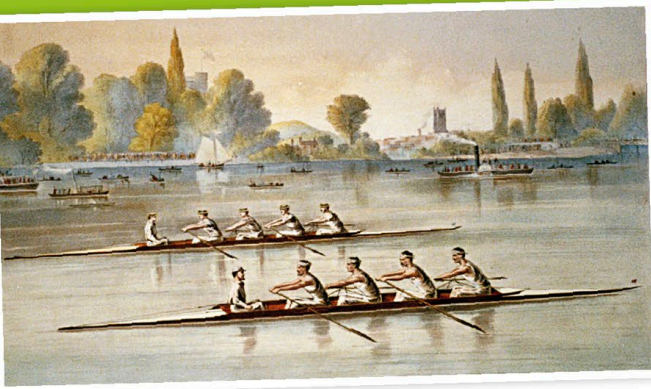
1896 The **Anglo-Zanzibar War** ended within just 45 minutes, making it the shortest war on record.

1964 A fantastical film about a magical nanny, *Mary Poppins*, premiered in Los Angeles, USA.

1869

Racing boats

The first international boat race took place on the River Thames in England. The UK's Oxford University beat the USA's Harvard University to the finish line. The race was widely reported in US newspapers.



Born this day

1908 **Don Bradman**, Australian cricketer. During his career, he racked up an incredible batting average of 99.94 runs per inning.

1958 **Sergei Krikalev**, cosmonaut (Russian astronaut). He has undertaken six space flights and spent 803 days in Earth's orbit.

1914

Modern zip

Swedish-American engineer Gideon Sundback filed an application to patent his invention of the zip. This was the first metallic fastener suited to everyday use and it transformed clothing, shoes, and bags in the years to come.

